

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Is the printer working?



Learning Outcome

Describe technology and technical problems in a wide range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What kind of technology do you have in your classroom or office?
- What do you do when you have a technological problem?

Can Do Statements

- I can ask for and offer help with technical problems.
- I can talk about technology and gadgets.
- I can describe a technical problem.





Let's Explore!

Janet talks to her secretary about a printer **malfunction***. What's wrong?

* A "malfunction" is when a piece of equipment fails to function properly.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Could you come and help me with the printer please?
- Secretary:** Certainly. What seems to be the problem with it? Is there a paper jam?
- Janet:** No. Yesterday all my documents were coming out streaky and I was having trouble with duplex printing as well. Today the printer is not printing at all!
- Secretary:** Has it gotten unplugged?
- Janet:** No, the lights are on and it's running.
- Secretary:** You said it was printing poorly yesterday but at least it was producing. Would you mind checking it to see if it has run out of paper? Check each of the input trays.
- Janet:** Let's see. No, that doesn't seem to be the problem. There is plenty of paper in all of those and the multipurpose trays.
- Secretary:** Does the dialogue box correspond with what you selected? Check the printer's pop-up menu.
- Janet:** Surprisingly there is no alert message on the printer display.
- Secretary:** Did you say that your documents came out spotty yesterday?
- Janet:** Yes. However nothing is happening today. You can hear the machine running but there is no output or indication of what the problem may be. Should we call in a technician?
- Secretary:** I think it is our only option. Should I contact a printer repair company or call in Joe?
- Janet:** I'd call Joe. We know that he is competent and what he charges. A large company will cost more and their services may not be any better.





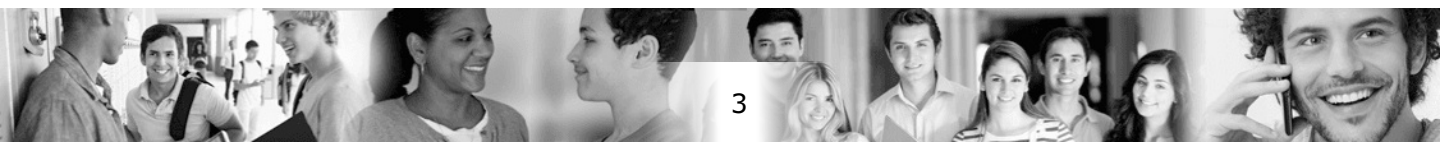
Let's Practice!

Asking for help with a technical problem.

Instructions: Read the text. Circle the correct option to complete the sentence. Practice saying the sentences (words) aloud with a partner. Correct each other.

1. Should you / Would I / Could you
2. came / come / coming
3. helped / help / was helping
4. Would you mind / Could I mind / Should you
5. check / checked / checking
6. Check / Checking / Checked
7. will seemed / seems / is seeming
8. Should / Does / Would
9. hear back / bring up / call in
10. had contacted / contacting / contact

1. _____ 2. _____ and 3. _____ me with the printer please?
4. _____ 5. _____ if it has run out of paper?
6. _____ the printer's pop- up menu and each of the sheet trays. What 7. _____ to be the problem with it?
8. _____ we 9. _____ a technician? Should I 10. _____ a printer repair company?





Let's Practice!

What's wrong with the printer?

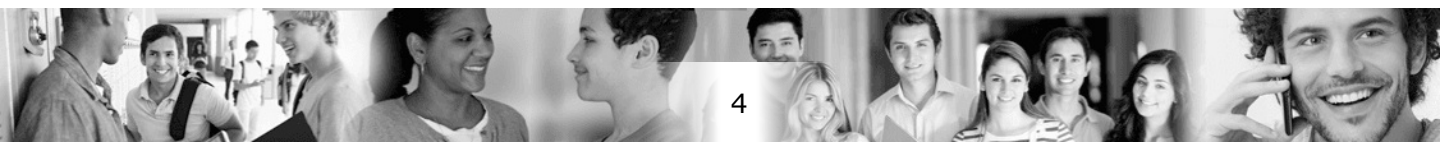
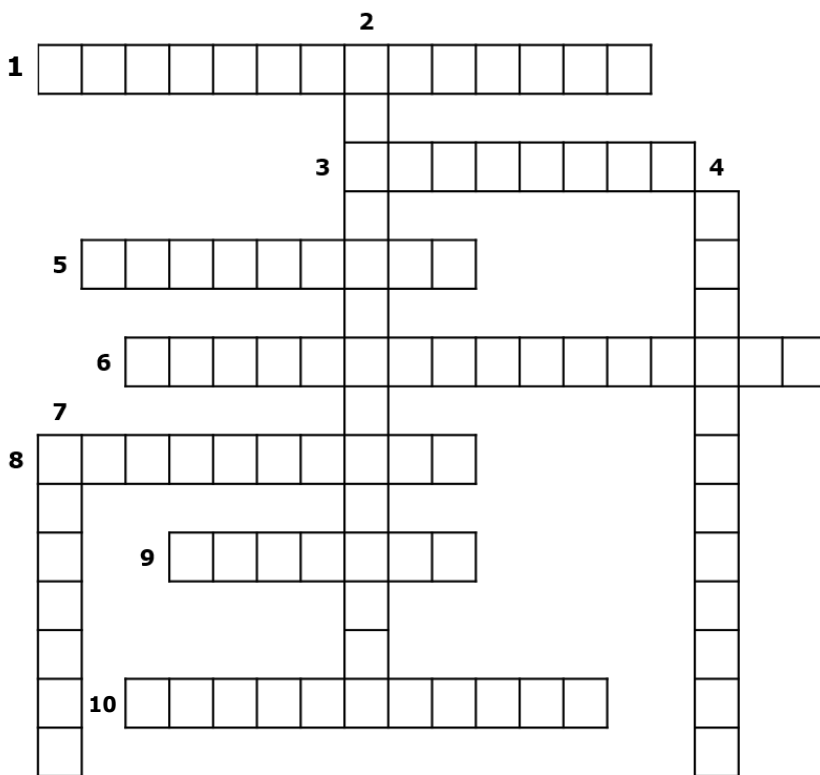
Instructions: Find out the words related to a printer machine. Read the clues. Write the corresponding word in the right box.

Across

1. a screen on a printer that shows alerts and messages
3. paper or other printed material that gets stuck in a printer and is unable to be removed
5. a selection of options that appears when you click on something on a device, such as a printer
6. the drawers of a printer where envelopes or thicker paper goes
8. a remark or sign that shows that something is happening
9. a machine which is connected to a computer and can make a printed record or computer information
10. a small area on a screen where information is given

Down

2. printing on both sides of a paper
4. a time-sensitive communication from a machine to a person
7. the drawers of a printer where plain paper goes





Extension Activity

Can you help me?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a piece of equipment or gadget in your class or office.
- Think about and write down a description of a problem that might happen to this piece of equipment or gadget.
- Write a short list of possible questions to ask and steps to follow.
- Read your instructions to your partner.
- Clarify any questions your partner might have.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about a piece of equipment or gadget that could have technical difficulties.

☐ ☐

I identify possible technical difficulties and describe them.

☐ ☐

I offer help on how to fix technical difficulties.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **printer** (noun): a machine which is connected to a computer and can make a printed record of computer information
e.g. The printer is not working.
- **paper jam** (noun): paper or other printed material that gets stuck in a printer and is unable to be removed
e.g. Is there a paper jam?
- **duplex printing** (noun): printing on both sides of a paper
e.g. I was having trouble with duplex printing as well.
- **multipurpose tray** (noun): the drawers of a printer where plain paper goes
e.g. There is plenty of paper in the multipurpose trays.
- **multipurpose tray** (noun): the drawers of a printer where envelopes or thicker paper goes
e.g. Is there any paper in the multipurpose trays?
- **dialogue box** (noun): a small area on a screen where information is given
e.g. Does the dialogue box correspond with what you selected?
- **pop-up menu** (noun): a selection of options that appears when you click on something on a device, such as a printer
e.g. Check the printer pop-up menu.
- **alert message** (noun): a time-sensitive communication from a machine to a person
e.g. There is an alert message telling me the printer will now turn off.
- **printer display** (noun): a screen on a printer that shows alerts and messages
e.g. There is no message on the printer display.
- **indication** (noun): a remark or sign that shows that something is happening
e.g. There is no indication of what the problem may be.





Learning Points

Using the Continuous Tenses to Describe Technical Problems

The Continuous Tenses are used to express the idea that something is or was happening at the moment of speaking. It can be used to describe technical problems you might encounter with technology in the workplace.

Look at the charts below to read about how the tenses are formed:

	The Past Continuous	The Present Continuous
Affirmative	subject + <i>was/were</i> + verb <i>-ing</i> <i>Yesterday it was printing properly.</i>	subject + <i>am/is/are</i> + verb <i>-ing</i> <i>It is printing properly.</i>
Negative	subject + <i>was/were</i> + <i>not</i> + verb <i>-ing</i> <i>The printer was not working.</i>	subject + <i>is</i> + <i>not</i> + verb <i>-ing</i> <i>The printer is not working.</i>

You can use the **Past** or **Present Continuous tense** to describe actions that are or were happening at the moment of speaking.

- *My internet is not working at all!*
- *My computer was producing yesterday.*

The **Past** and **Present Continuous** are also used to describe actions or situations that were in progress around the present or past time, but not necessarily at the moment of speaking.

- **Rick:** Hey, what **were you doing** in the cafeteria this morning?
- **Bill:** I **was taking a break** but **I'm fixing** Marie's printer.

Contractions are often used in spoken English. When using the **Present Continuous tense** people more frequently use "*'s not/'re not + -ing*" than "*isn't/aren't + -ing*".

- *The lights aren't running on the printer.*





Learning Points

Asking For and Offering Help with Technical Problems

Often in the workplace, you will have issues with technology. Your printer may stop printing, your internet may stop working, and your screen may freeze. When you face any of these issues, you will need to ask for help and sometimes offer help with these problems. Here's some language you can use:

- Use **modal verbs** to ask for help with technical problems.
 - *Could you help me connect to the internet, please?*
 - *Should we call in someone?*
 - *Would you mind checking if it has run out of ink?*
- Use **imperatives** (the base form of the verb) to tell people to do something.
 - *Check the paper trays.*
 - *Make sure it is working.*
- Use the **Present Simple tense** to ask questions or when troubleshooting.
 - *What seems to be the problem?*
 - *There is a signal coming from the modem.*
 - *Does it correspond with what you see on your computer?*

